

TN SKILL PROJECT

Eight-Phase Project Plan & Implementation Document

Project: Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Platform	ServiceNow
Automation Tool	Flow Designer
Business Area	IT Procurement / Hardware Configuration
Core Workflow	Standard Laptop request → approval → automated catalog task → Hardware assignment
Team	4 members including Team Leader

Source basis: This document is prepared directly from the supplied project document. It preserves the source project's problem statement, user story, objectives, ServiceNow Flow Designer configuration, flow assignment, service catalog ordering, approval, catalog-task verification, and conclusion. Where the requested eight-phase structure goes beyond the source's explicit headings, the material is organized into the eight phases without changing the project's core scope.

Project Overview

The project addresses inefficiencies in IT procurement for standard laptop orders. The supplied project document states that standard laptop requests can require configuration, but manual handling can lead to oversight or delay. The proposed solution is an automated ServiceNow workflow using Flow Designer that creates and assigns a catalog task to the Hardware team after approval, so configuration work is initiated promptly.

The project objective is to provide a seamless requesting experience, reduce manual intervention and potential errors, improve IT resource utilisation, and increase procurement efficiency and productivity.

End-to-end process

1. A user places a Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog.
2. The request proceeds for approval.
3. After approval, the Flow Designer automation creates a Catalog Task.
4. The task receives the short description and description "Laptop need to Configured".
5. The Assignment group is set to Hardware.
6. The approved Requested Item contains the resulting catalog task, where its updated status and assignment can be verified.

The source document explicitly defines the flow name as "Standard laptop task", the application as Global, the run user as System user, the Service Catalog trigger, and the Create Catalog Task action.

Phase 1: Brainstorming & Ideation

Purpose: Identify the operational problem and convert it into a focused automation idea.

Problem identified

The current IT procurement process has manual overhead and can cause delays in standard laptop requests, especially when configuration is required. The project document specifically identifies the risk of configuration oversight or delay and its effect on users and IT resource allocation.

User story

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the Hardware team for configuration. This is intended to ensure that laptops are configured promptly after arrival, reducing user wait time and manual intervention.

Proposed idea

- Use ServiceNow Service Catalog as the request entry point for the Standard Laptop item.
- Use Flow Designer to automate the creation of a Catalog Task after the request is approved.
- Populate the task with a clear configuration description.
- Automatically assign the task to the Hardware group.
- Verify the generated Catalog Task from the Requested Item record.

Expected value

- More consistent handling of standard laptop requests.
- Less manual task creation and assignment.
- Reduced chance of configuration work being overlooked.
- Better visibility of the configuration task in the Requested Item.
- More efficient use of the Hardware team's time.

Ideation output

Selected concept: Automate standard laptop configuration task creation and Hardware assignment through ServiceNow Flow Designer after request approval.

Phase 2: Requirement Analysis

Purpose: Convert the project idea into functional requirements that can be configured and verified in ServiceNow.

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement	Source-supported implementation
FR-01	A Standard Laptop item must be available in the Service Catalog.	Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop.
FR-02	The request must proceed through approval.	The source verifies the Approvers section and approval of the record.
FR-03	An automation must create a Catalog Task after the request is approved.	Flow Designer with Service Catalog trigger and Create Catalog Task action.
FR-04	The task must reference the Requested Item.	Requested Item Record is dragged into Request item.
FR-05	Task short description must be populated.	"Laptop need to Configured".
FR-06	Task description must be populated.	"Laptop need to Configured".
FR-07	Task must be assigned to Hardware.	Assignment group = Hardware.
FR-08	The approval value used by the action must be Approved.	Approval field value = Approved.
FR-09	The flow must be attached to the Standard Laptop catalog item.	Maintain Items → Standard Laptop → Process engine → Flow.

Non-functional expectations

- Automation should reduce unnecessary manual intervention.
- The workflow should support timely configuration task generation.
- Task ownership should be clear through the Hardware assignment group.
- The resulting task should be visible for verification from the Requested Item.

Requirement-analysis acceptance points

- Standard Laptop can be ordered.
- Approval can be completed.
- Approved request causes the configured flow to run.
- Catalog Task is created against the Requested Item.
- Short description and description are populated.
- Assignment group is Hardware.
- The final Catalog Task record can be opened and its updated values verified.

Phase 3: Project Design

Purpose: Design the ServiceNow objects, automation sequence, data flow, and verification path before implementation.

High-level architecture

User → Service Catalog → Standard Laptop → Approval → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware Assignment → Catalog Task verification

Flow design

Design element	Configured value
Flow name	Standard laptop task
Application	Global
Run user	System user
Trigger	Service Catalog
Action	Create Catalog Task
Request item input	Requested Item Record
Table	Automatically populated as Catalog Task
Short description	Laptop need to Configured
Description	Laptop need to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval field	Approved

Design of the catalog-item connection

- Open Maintain Items and select Standard Laptop.
- Open Process engine.
- Remove remaining automations, then add the configured Flow.
- Select the flow named Standard Laptop Task.
- Save the catalog item record.

Design verification path

- Open Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop.
- Use Order Now to place the request.
- Open the order status and Request Number.
- Review the Approvers section and approve the request.
- Open the Requested Item.
- Scroll to Catalog Tasks and open the task to verify status, short description, and assignment group.

Design output

A complete logical workflow is defined from request initiation through approval, automated task creation, Hardware assignment, and final verification.

Phase 4: Project Planning

Purpose: Organise implementation activities, responsibilities, sequence, and completion checkpoints for a four-member student team.

Suggested 4-member work allocation

Role	Primary responsibility	Deliverables
Team Leader / Member 1	Overall coordination; flow configuration; integration; final validation.	Flow, integration checklist, final demo readiness.
Member 2	Service Catalog and Standard Laptop item setup; request/approval verification.	Catalog-item configuration and approval test evidence.
Member 3	Testing, screenshots/evidence, documentation and PPT support.	Test cases, evidence, documentation/PPT inputs.

Implementation schedule

Stage	Planned work	Completion evidence
1. Setup	Open ServiceNow and access Flow Designer / relevant modules.	Environment ready.
2. Flow build	Create Standard laptop task flow, trigger, and Create Catalog Task action.	Saved flow configuration.
3. Activation	Save and activate the flow.	Active flow.
4. Catalog assignment	Attach flow to Standard Laptop in Maintain Items → Process engine.	Catalog item linked to flow.
5. Transaction test	Order Standard Laptop and complete approval.	Approved request.
6. Task verification	Open Requested Item → Catalog Tasks and verify fields.	Correct task record.
7. Documentation	Capture screenshots, steps, results, and lessons learned.	Final report/PPT.

Planning checkpoints

- Do not move to final documentation until the flow is activated and the Standard Laptop item is linked to it.
- Run at least one complete request-to-task verification cycle before the demonstration.
- Keep screenshots of the important configuration and final task result.
- Use the exact source terminology in the final presentation: Standard Laptop, Standard laptop task, Service Catalog, Flow Designer, Create Catalog Task, Hardware, Approved, Requested Item, Catalog Tasks.

Phase 5: Project Development

Purpose: Implement the designed automation in ServiceNow Flow Designer and connect it to the Standard Laptop service catalog item.

Development Activity 1 - Create the Flow

- Open ServiceNow.
- Select All and search for Flow Designer.
- Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.
- Click New and select Flow.
- Set Flow Name to "Standard laptop task".
- Set Application to Global.
- Set Run user to "System user".
- Click Submit.

Development Activity 2 - Configure the Trigger

- Click Add a trigger.
- Search for "Service Catalog".
- Select the Service Catalog trigger.
- Click Done.

Development Activity 3 - Configure the Action

- Under Actions, click Add an action.
- Search for and select "Create Catalog Task".
- Set Action to Create Catalog Task.
- Drag and drop the Requested Item Record into Request item.
- Allow the table to populate as Catalog Task.
- Set Short description to "Laptop need to Configured".
- Add the Description field with value "Laptop need to Configured".
- Set Assignment group to "Hardware".
- Set Approval to "Approved".
- Leave remaining fields at their defaults.
- Click Done.

Development Activity 4 - Save and Activate

- Save the Flow.
- Click Activate.
- Click Activate again when prompted.

Development Activity 5 - Assign the Flow to Standard Laptop

- Open All and search for Maintain Items.
- Select Maintain Items.

- Search the Name field for Standard Laptop and select the record.
- Open Process engine.
- Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
- Add the flow named “Standard Laptop Task”.
- Save the record.

Development output

The implemented solution is an active Flow Designer workflow connected to the Standard Laptop catalog item, with an approved Service Catalog request triggering creation of a Hardware-assigned Catalog Task.

Phase 6: Project Testing

Purpose: Confirm that the implemented workflow behaves according to the project requirements.

Test scenario

Place a Standard Laptop order, complete the approval, then verify that the automation creates a Catalog Task with the expected values and Hardware assignment.

Test cases

TC	Test action	Expected result
TC-01	Open Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop.	Standard Laptop item is available.
TC-02	Click Order Now and place the request.	Order/request is created and an order status can be viewed.
TC-03	Open Request Number and Approvers section.	Approval record is available.
TC-04	Approve the request.	Requested Item reaches Approved state for the configured flow condition.
TC-05	Open the Requested Item and Catalog Tasks section.	A Catalog Task has been created by the flow.
TC-06	Open the Catalog Task record.	Short description is "Laptop need to Configured".
TC-07	Inspect task description.	Description is "Laptop need to Configured".
TC-08	Inspect Assignment group.	Assignment group is Hardware.
TC-09	Inspect task/status information.	Updated task status/details are visible for verification.

Testing checklist

- Flow is active.
- Standard Laptop catalog item uses the configured flow.
- Request can be submitted.
- Approval can be completed.
- Catalog Task is created after approval.
- Requested Item is correctly linked to the task.
- Short description and description are populated.
- Assignment group is Hardware.
- Final task record can be opened and inspected.

Defect handling

If a test fails, verify the flow trigger, Requested Item input, approval value, task field values, flow activation status, and the Process engine configuration of the Standard Laptop item before rerunning the test.

Phase 7: Project Documentation

Purpose: Produce a clear record of the project so another student, evaluator, or team member can understand what was built and how it was verified.

Recommended documentation structure

1. Project Title

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer.

2. Problem Statement

Explain the manual overhead and delays associated with standard laptop requests and configuration.

3. User Story

Describe the IT procurement team member's need for automatically generated and Hardware-assigned configuration tasks.

4. Project Objectives

List the four objectives: seamless user experience, reduced manual intervention/errors, improved resource utilisation, and improved efficiency/productivity.

5. Requirements

Document the functional requirements and expected outcomes.

6. System Design

Show the request → approval → flow → catalog task → Hardware assignment sequence.

7. Implementation

Document Flow Designer creation, trigger, Create Catalog Task action, field values, activation, and catalog-item flow assignment.

8. Testing

Include test cases, expected results, actual results, and screenshots.

9. Demonstration

Describe the live sequence used during the demo.

10. Conclusion

Summarise how the automation reduces manual overhead and supports timely configuration.

Evidence / screenshot checklist

- Flow Designer – Flow properties showing Standard laptop task, Global, and System user.
- Trigger configuration showing Service Catalog.
- Create Catalog Task action showing Requested Item Record.
- Action fields showing short description, description, Hardware, and Approved.
- Activated flow.
- Maintain Items → Standard Laptop → Process engine showing the assigned flow.
- Service Catalog → Hardware → Standard Laptop.

- Order status and Request Number.
- Approvers section showing approval.
- Requested Item → Catalog Tasks.
- Final Catalog Task showing updated status, short description, and assigned group.

Documentation quality rule

Use screenshots that clearly show the relevant field or record. Keep names and terminology consistent with the configured project. Do not add unsupported technical claims that are not part of the implemented workflow.

Phase 8: Project Demonstration

Purpose: Demonstrate the complete business flow and prove that the automation works from request to task assignment.

Recommended live demonstration sequence

1. Introduce the problem: standard laptop procurement can involve manual configuration-task handling.
2. State the solution: ServiceNow Flow Designer automates creation and assignment of the configuration task.
3. Open Service Catalog.
4. Navigate to Hardware and select Standard Laptop.
5. Click Order Now and place the request.
6. Open the order status and Request Number.
7. Open the Approvers section and approve the request.
8. Open the Requested Item.
9. Scroll to Catalog Tasks.
10. Open the generated Catalog Task.
11. Show the updated task status/details.
12. Show Short description = "Laptop need to Configured".
13. Show Assignment group = Hardware.
14. Conclude by explaining that the task was generated automatically after approval, reducing manual intervention.

Suggested presentation flow

Slide	Content
1	Project title and team members
2	Problem statement
3	User story and objectives
4	Current problem vs automated approach
5	System/workflow design
6	Flow Designer configuration
7	Standard Laptop catalog-item flow assignment
8	Request and approval process
9	Generated Catalog Task and Hardware assignment
10	Testing results and screenshots
11	Conclusion and benefits

Demo success criteria

- The presenter can explain the problem and objective in simple terms.
- The Standard Laptop item can be located and ordered.

- The request can be approved.
- The generated Catalog Task can be located.
- The task shows the intended description and Hardware assignment.
- The team can explain how Flow Designer connects the request and task.

Final conclusion

The supplied project demonstrates an automated standard laptop procurement workflow in ServiceNow using Flow Designer. The automation creates a Catalog Task after the Service Catalog request is approved, populates the task with the configuration description, and assigns it to the Hardware group. This directly addresses the project's stated aim of reducing manual overhead, improving task allocation, supporting timely configuration, and improving the user experience.

Source note

All project-specific configuration values and implementation steps in this document are based on the supplied project PDF. The eight-phase structure is an organized project-management presentation of that source material.